

Global Employee Policy Handbook

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Purpose Statement: This Employee Policy Handbook defines the global employment frameworks, professional standards, and operational mechanics for our global IT Consulting operations. As a technology-forward enterprise, we operate across multiple international jurisdictions under a unified standard of professional delivery, digital security, and human centricity.

1. Introduction & Cultural Architecture

1.1 Welcome to the Future of IT Consulting

Welcome to our global network. As a leading IT Consulting Multinational Corporation (MNC), our competitive advantage rests entirely on our collective intellectual capital, our technical agility, and the uncompromising integrity of our workforce. We partner with world-class enterprises to solve highly complex technological challenges.

This handbook establishes the operational blueprint, legal guardrails, and behavioral expectations that define our culture. It serves as a binding operational framework for all full-time employees, contractors, and regional staff across all corporate locations globally.

1.2 Our Operating Philosophy: Agility, Autonomy, Accountability

We operate under a high-trust, high-performance paradigm. Our distributed team architecture requires every consultant, engineer, and corporate strategist to champion three core operational principles:

- **Agility:** Adapting rapidly to evolving technical architectures, changing market demands, and client environments.
- **Autonomy:** Taking radical ownership of project deliverables, technical outcomes, and continuous professional development without requiring micro-management.
- **Accountability:** Maintaining an unyielding commitment to code quality, project deadlines, data security, and transparent client communication.

2. Global Code of Conduct & Ethical Frameworks

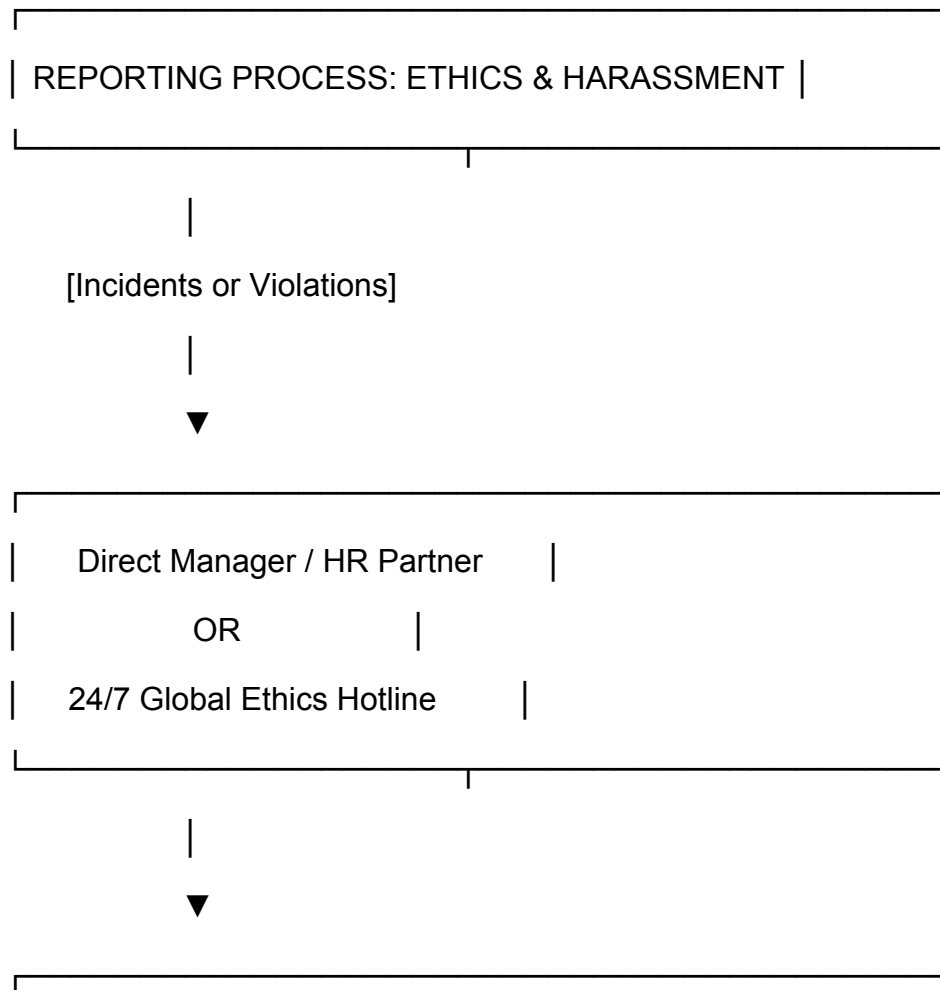
2.1 Non-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment

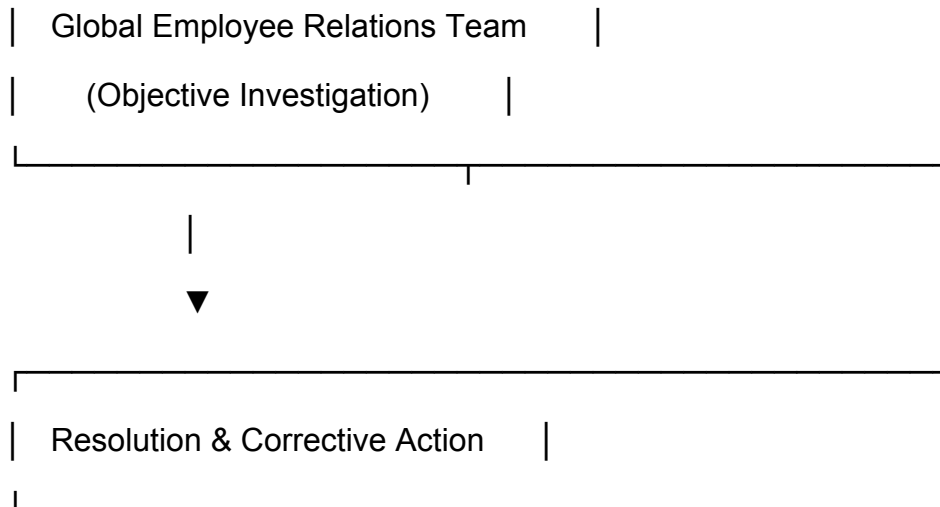
We are committed to a working environment completely free of discrimination, harassment, and retaliation.

Prohibited Conduct

We strictly prohibit discrimination or harassment based on race, color, religion, creed, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, age, sex, gender identity, gender expression, sexual orientation, marital status, physical or mental disability, genetic information, military or veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable local, national, or international laws.

This policy governs all aspects of employment, including recruiting, hiring, placement, promotion, termination, layoff, recall, transfer, leaves of absence, compensation, and training.





Remediation and Non-Retaliation

Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination or harassment must immediately report the incident to their regional Human Resources Partner or via the secure, anonymous **Global Ethics Hotline**.

All reports are investigated within 72 business hours by the Global Employee Relations Team. Retaliation against any individual who reports discrimination or harassment, or who participates in an investigation, is a zero-tolerance offense resulting in immediate termination of employment.

2.2 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH Framework)

In alignment with global statutory mandates—including the Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) frameworks across our Asian operations, Title VII of the Civil Rights Act in the United States, and the European Social Charter—the company maintains an absolute zero-tolerance policy toward sexual harassment.

- **Definition:** Sexual harassment includes unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal, visual, or physical conduct of a sexual nature when submission to or rejection of this conduct explicitly or implicitly affects an individual's employment, unreasonably interferes with an individual's work performance, or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.
- **Internal Complaints Committees (ICC):** Every regional legal entity maintains a localized Internal Complaints Committee chaired by a senior female employee, featuring external legal or civil society experts. The ICC holds quasi-judicial powers to investigate, document, and recommend strict disciplinary actions, up to and including immediate summary dismissal and criminal prosecution.

2.3 Conflicts of Interest and Moonlighting

Our consultants are trusted with proprietary client strategies, architectural roadmaps, and highly sensitive system access.

Outside Employment (Moonlighting)

Employees must devote their full professional attention, skills, and energy to the organization during their contractual working hours. Engaging in secondary employment, freelance consulting, or contract work for external entities ("moonlighting") is strictly prohibited unless written clearance is granted in advance by the Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) and Global Legal Counsel. Under no circumstances may an employee perform outside work that utilizes company-owned hardware, software licenses, intellectual property, or proprietary methodologies.

Financial Interests

Employees must disclose any direct or indirect financial interests, investments, or advisory roles they or their immediate family members hold in any entity that is a direct competitor, client, vendor, or supplier of the organization.

2.4 Anti-Bribery, Corruption, and Corporate Gift Policies

We strictly comply with the **US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA)**, the **UK Bribery Act**, and all local anti-corruption statutes across our operating regions.

- **Bribery Prohibitions:** Employees may not offer, give, solicit, or receive any form of bribe, kickback, facilitation payment, or inappropriate benefit to or from any client, government official, public authority, or third party to secure a business advantage.
- **Corporate Gifts:** The giving or receiving of business gifts, hospitality, or entertainment is permitted only if it is of nominal value (not exceeding \$50 USD or regional equivalent), directly related to standard business relationship cultivation, completely transparent, and fully logged within the corporate *Global Gift & Hospitality Registry*.

3. Workplace Models, Attendance, & Lifecycle Management

3.1 Distributed Work Matrices: Remote, Hybrid, and On-Site

To maintain talent density and operational flexibility, our organization utilizes a data-driven, client-aligned workspace structure categorized into three primary operational profiles:

Workplace Model	Structural Requirements	Core Operational Mandate
Fully Remote	Approved for specific engineering, research, and non-client-facing roles. Requires a certified home office infrastructure.	Must maintain core operating hour availability and sync daily with regional agile teams.
Hybrid Mode	The standard operating model for the majority of our technology consultants and enterprise architects.	Requires 2 designated collaborative days per week inside a regional corporate office, with 3 days flexible remote.
On-Site (Client/HQ)	Mandated for high-security projects, classified defense/banking cloud operations, and specific deployment phases.	Requires full-time presence at either a designated corporate hub or a dedicated client facility.

3.2 Time Tracking, Attendance, and Sprint Allocations

As an IT consulting firm, our corporate revenue and operational metrics are directly tied to clean project accounting.

- **Timesheet Compliance:** All billable and non-billable employees must log their daily project allocations, internal R&D allocations, and administrative time within the enterprise resource planning (ERP) system by 18:00 local time every Friday. Inaccurate logging or failure to submit timesheets for two consecutive weeks constitutes a material breach of the performance code.
- **Core Working Hours:** Regardless of physical location, all employees must remain accessible via enterprise communication nodes (Slack, Microsoft Teams) during the designated regional core hours of **10:00 to 16:00** in their primary employment timezone.

3.3 Performance Evaluation Architecture

We reject archaic, annual performance review systems. Instead, the company utilizes a continuous feedback and technical growth architecture:

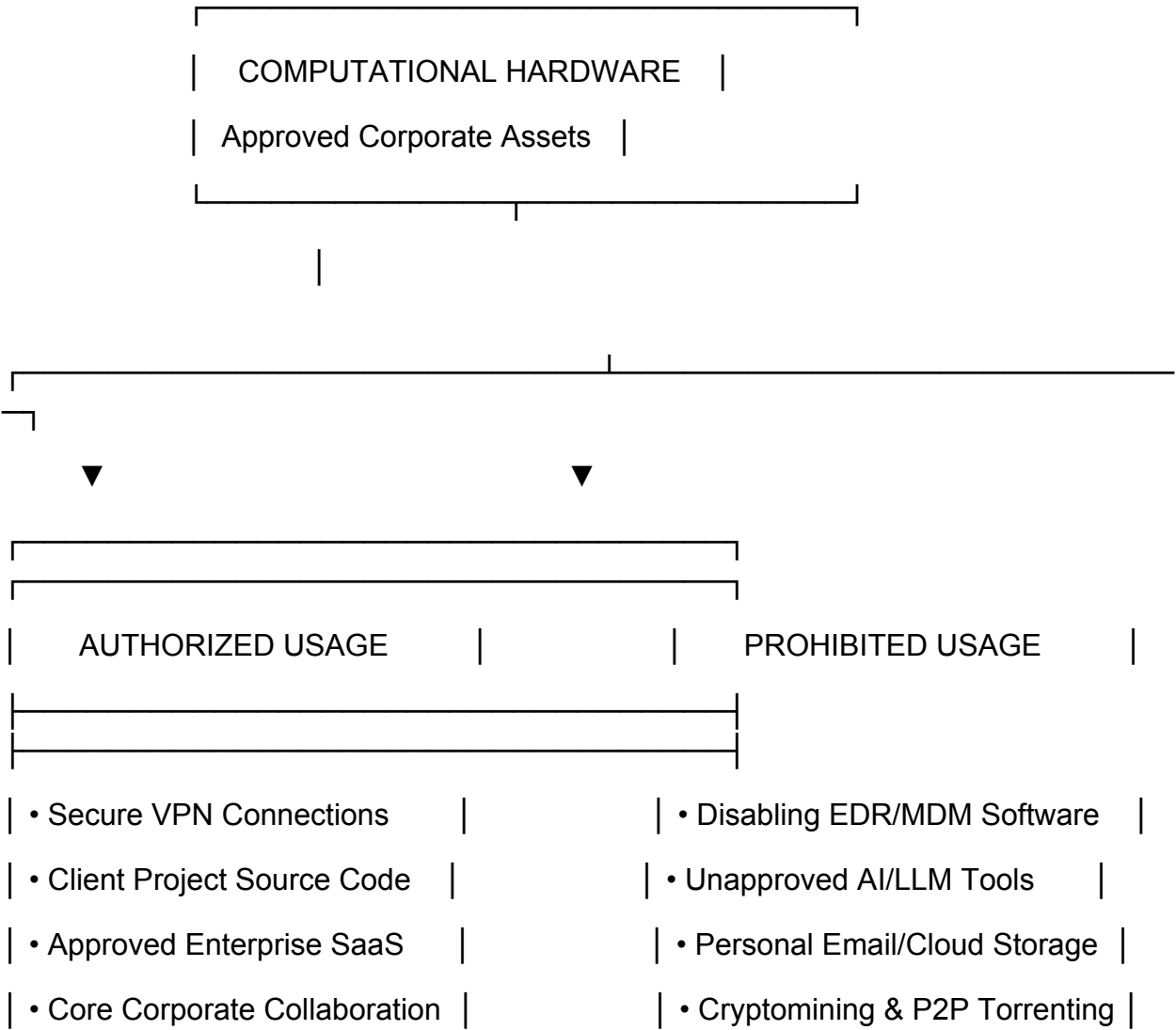
- **Objective and Key Results (OKRs):** Company, team, and individual OKRs are updated, calibrated, and evaluated on a quarterly cadence.
- **360-Degree Continuous Feedback:** Employees receive automated, anonymized peer, client, and managerial feedback at the conclusion of every project delivery sprint or quarterly milestone.

- **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP):** If an employee's technical delivery or professional conduct consistently falls below baseline benchmarks, they may be placed on a structured, 45-day Performance Improvement Plan. The PIP explicitly defines the required technical metrics, daily evaluation checkpoints, and clear outcomes. Failure to successfully graduate from a PIP within the defined timeframe results in immediate termination of the employment contract.

4. Global Data Security, Privacy, & Infrastructure Use

4.1 Global Information Security Policy (Acceptable Use)

Every employee is a custodian of our digital perimeter. All computational activities must strictly conform to our **ISO/IEC 27001:2022** and **SOC 2 Type II** certified Information Security standards.



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- **Asset Ownership:** All hardware (laptops, mobile devices, security keys) provided by the company remains the exclusive property of the organization. Employees have no expectation of personal privacy regarding any data transmitted, received, created, or stored on corporate assets.
 - **Security Control Configurations:** Employees are strictly prohibited from disabling, altering, or bypassing endpoint detection and response (EDR) software, mobile device management (MDM) profiles, corporate firewalls, or multi-factor authentication (MFA) parameters.
 - **Prohibited Software & Activities:** The installation of unauthorized peer-to-peer file-sharing applications, cryptocurrency mining software, personal cloud storage sync tools, or unvetted third-party browser extensions is entirely forbidden.

4.2 Data Privacy Compliance (GDPR, CCPA, and Regional Acts)

Operating globally requires unyielding compliance with data protection laws, including the **European Union General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR)**, the **California Consumer Privacy Act (CCPA)**, and regional Data Protection Acts across various global jurisdictions.

- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** Employees handling customer, client, or employee PII must strictly process data according to the principles of data minimization, purpose limitation, and storage limitation. No PII may be transferred across international borders without explicitly validated data transfer mechanisms (such as Standard Contractual Clauses).
- **Data Breach Notification:** Any employee who detects or suspects a potential data leak, unauthorized system access, phishing compromise, or lost corporate hardware must report the incident to the **Global Security Operations Center (GSOC)** within 15 minutes of discovery.

4.3 Generative AI and Third-Party LLM Usage Policies

As a technology-forward organization, we encourage the innovative, responsible use of artificial intelligence. However, to safeguard corporate intellectual property and client confidentiality, the following restrictions are strictly enforced:

- **Input Constraints:** Employees must never input client source code, proprietary algorithms, unannounced corporate financials, strategic roadmaps, or employee PII into any public, consumer-grade Generative AI models or Large Language

Models (LLMs) (e.g., standard consumer versions of ChatGPT, Claude, Midjourney).

- **Approved Enterprise Tooling:** Only company-provisioned, enterprise-tier AI instances featuring documented data-opt-out clauses (where inputs are not utilized for public model training) are permitted for engineering and administrative workflows. All AI-generated source code must undergo standard human peer review and automated security scanning prior to production deployment.

5. Intellectual Property & Confidentiality

5.1 Proprietary Information and Inventions Agreement (PIIA)

Every employee must execute and uphold the provisions of the comprehensive Global Proprietary Information and Inventions Agreement (PIIA) signed at the inception of their employment.

- **Definition of Confidential Information:** This encompasses all non-public information, including but not limited to source code, system architectures, database schemas, financial models, client rosters, fee structures, advanced project methodologies, and unannounced commercial partnerships.
- **Survival of Obligations:** The obligation to maintain absolute confidentiality regarding this information survives the termination of employment indefinitely, regardless of the reason for separation.

5.2 Assignment of Inventions and Patents

- **Work for Hire:** Any and all intellectual property, source code, scripts, system frameworks, business processes, whitepapers, or patents developed, authored, or conceived by an employee during their period of employment—either within regular working hours or utilizing company resources—is automatically classified as a "Work for Hire" and remains the exclusive global property of the organization.
- **Moral Rights Waiver:** Employees explicitly waive any and all moral rights to intellectual property created during their tenure, ensuring the organization maintains unfettered rights to modify, sell, license, or exploit these assets globally.

6. Global Benefits, Compensation, & Leaves

6.1 Total Rewards Architecture

We maintain a highly competitive Total Rewards philosophy designed to attract, motivate, and retain top-tier consulting and engineering talent.

- **Base Salary Benchmarking:** Base salaries are audited annually by external compensation analysts to ensure equity and competitive positioning within the upper quartile of regional IT consulting markets.
- **Performance Bonuses and Equity Grants:** Billable consultants and executives are eligible for performance bonuses tied directly to individual utilization rates, client satisfaction metrics (NPS), and regional corporate profitability. Eligible technical leads and executives participate in the Global Employee Stock Option Plan (ESOP), subject to cliff and vesting structures managed by the Board's Compensation Committee.

6.2 Global Leave Frameworks

To guarantee sustainable high performance, we provide comprehensive time-off structures tailored to meet or exceed regional statutory baselines:

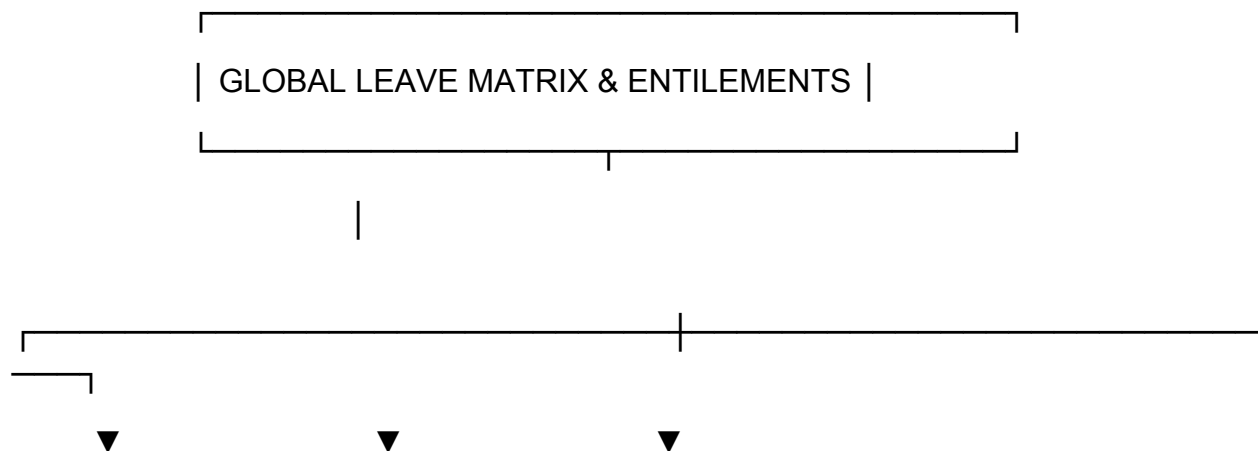
Annual Paid Time Off (PTO)

Employees accrue paid vacation days on a monthly cadence, up to a global baseline standard of 25 business days per calendar year, exclusive of localized statutory public holidays. A maximum of 5 unused PTO days may be carried forward into the subsequent calendar year; all other excess accrued leave is subject to regional cash-encashment or expiration laws.

Parental Leave Matrix

We provide a gender-neutral, globally inclusive parental leave framework:

- **Primary Caregiver Leave:** Up to 18 weeks of fully paid leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child.
- **Secondary Caregiver Leave:** Up to 8 weeks of fully paid leave to support family expansion.



ANNUAL PAID LEAVE	PARENTAL LEAVE SICK & WELLNESS
• 25 Days/Year	• 18 Wks Primary • 12 Days/Year
• 5 Days Carryover	• 8 Wks Secondary • Mental Health

Medical and Mental Health Wellness Leave

Employees receive 12 fully paid medical leave days annually for personal illness or medical appointments. Recognizing the cognitive demands of IT consulting, the organization also provides 2 dedicated, fully paid "Mental Health & Decompression Days" per calendar year, accessible without medical documentation.

7. Travel, Expenses, & Client Engagements

7.1 Global Corporate Travel Policy

As an IT consulting organization, our professionals regularly travel to international client sites. All corporate travel must be booked exclusively through the corporate travel management portal and comply strictly with the following parameters:

- **Air Travel Standards:** Flights under 6 hours must be booked in Economy or Premium Economy Class. Flights exceeding 6 continuous hours of travel are eligible for Business Class booking, subject to written authorization from the regional Practice Director.
- **Accommodation and Lodging:** Lodging must be secured at approved corporate-tier partner hotels. Daily spend limits are strictly capped based on destination tiering, as continuously updated within the Travel Portal Expense Guidelines.

7.2 Expense Reimbursement Protocols

All business-related expenses incurred on behalf of the company must be documented, reconciled, and submitted for approval via the enterprise expense platform by the last day of the calendar month.

- **Valid Expenses:** Client entertainment (within pre-approved project budgets), project-specific cellular/internet stipends, hardware accessories purchased via IT procurement workflows, and reasonable client-site meals.
- **Non-Reimbursable Items:** Alcoholic beverages outside organized client events, personal grooming items, traffic or parking citations, flight upgrades unauthorized by travel management, and expenses lacking valid, itemized tax invoices. Submitting fraudulent expense reports constitutes financial misconduct and is grounds for immediate termination with cause.

8. Health, Safety, & Employee Well-being

8.1 Workplace Ergonomics and Digital Health

Whether working from a corporate headquarters or a home environment, the physical well-being of our technical workforce is a priority.

- **Ergonomic Assessments:** The company provides access to virtual ergonomic evaluations conducted by certified safety professionals. Employees are eligible for a regional stipend to purchase certified ergonomic task chairs and sit-stand desks to mitigate repetitive strain injuries (RSI).
- **Digital Fatigue Mitigation:** We champion a "Right to Disconnect" philosophy. Except during critical product deployments, server infrastructure failures, or active high-priority client incidents, employees are discouraged from sending internal communications or requesting project deliverables between the hours of 20:00 and 08:00 local time.

8.2 Workplace Violence and Threat Management

The organization enforces a zero-tolerance policy regarding workplace violence, physical altercations, verbal intimidation, bullying, or threats of harm directed at employees, clients, vendors, or visitors.

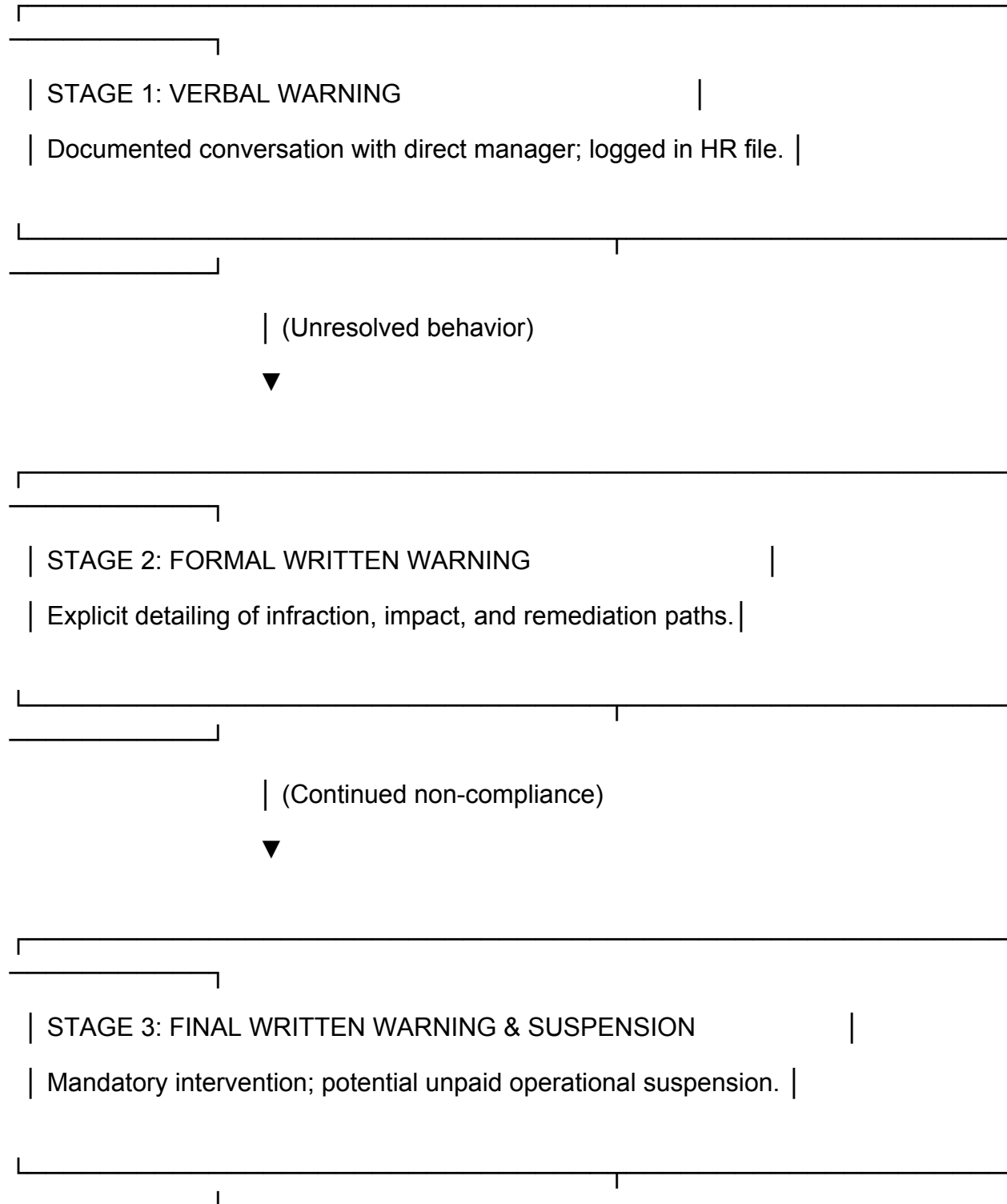
Bringing weapons of any kind—regardless of local concealed-carry permits—into a corporate facility, client site, or company-sponsored event is strictly prohibited. Violations will result in immediate removal, termination of employment with cause, and referral to law enforcement agencies.

9. Progressive Disciplinary Matrix & Separation Protocols

9.1 The Progressive Disciplinary Framework

To maintain clear accountability, minor infractions or performance gaps are addressed through a transparent progressive disciplinary process. However, the company explicitly

retains the right to bypass any step in this framework if the severity of the misconduct warrants immediate termination.



| (Failure to remediate)



| STAGE 4: TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT |

| Permanent separation from the organization with/without cause. |

9.2 Summary Dismissal (Termination with Cause)

Immediate termination of employment without notice, pay in lieu of notice, or severance compensation will occur if an employee commits an act of gross misconduct. Gross misconduct includes, but is not limited to:

- Theft, embezzlement, or corporate financial fraud.
- Material breaches of global data security policies leading to system compromise or data exposure.
- Physical violence, sexual harassment, or egregious discriminatory behavior.
- Falsification of employment records, resumes, or client-facing project tracking data.
- Conviction of an indictable criminal offense during tenure.

9.3 Separation, Off-boarding, and Asset Retrieval

Upon separation from the organization, whether voluntary or involuntary, a structured off-boarding sequence is executed:

- **Notice Periods:** Unless explicitly modified by individual employment contracts or local labor statutes, the standard notice period for voluntary resignation is **30 calendar days** for consulting staff and **90 calendar days** for Principal Architects, Practice Directors, and Executive Leadership.
- **Knowledge Transfer:** The departing employee must actively participate in structured knowledge-transfer sessions, document all active code repositories, and hand over architectural credentials to a designated team lead.

- **Asset Reclamation:** All corporate hardware, building access tokens, tokens for physical authentication, and enterprise software accounts will be revoked or collected on the final active day of employment. Final salary payouts and statutory gratuities or severance distributions will be processed through regional payroll bureaus only upon the validation of a clean *Global Asset Retrieval Sign-off*.

10. Appendix: Country-Specific Addenda and Statutory Overrides

This handbook outlines our global corporate standards. Where local, municipal, state, or national laws impose stricter requirements or grant employees broader rights than those articulated in this document, the local statutory mandates automatically supersede these corporate provisions. Employees should reference their regional country-specific addenda—maintained by their regional HR Operations Hub—for detailed guidance on local labor courts, statutory retirement contributions, tax withholdings, and localized mandatory benefits.

11. Employee Acknowledgment & Digital Sign-off

I hereby acknowledge that I have received, read, and fully understood the Global Employee Policy Handbook (version 4.1). I agree to strictly adhere to the policies, code of conduct, data security rules, and ethical frameworks set forth herein as a condition of my continued employment with the organization.

Employee Digital Signature: _____

Employee Printed Name: _____

Global Employee ID Number: _____

Date of Execution: _____